

Abraham's Faith Journey: Trusting When You Can't See

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 51 of 60

Scene 1 of 25

[PICTURE: A bustling ancient city of Ur with ziggurats and temples in the background. Abram stands apart from the crowd, looking upward toward the sky with a searching expression while others bow before stone idols. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

In the ancient city of Ur of the Chaldeans — one of the most advanced civilizations of its time — a man named Abram lived among idol worshippers. The city boasted towering ziggurats, sophisticated trade routes, and a deeply entrenched polytheistic culture. Yet something stirred within Abram's spirit, an unshakable sense that the stone gods surrounding him were empty and powerless. He could not yet name what he was searching for, but his soul hungered for something — Someone — beyond the visible world. Sometimes the journey of faith begins not with answers, but with a holy dissatisfaction with the way things are.

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(Ab'ta tintawit ketema Ur nay Keledawyan — nay gize'a kab zimaabellu silttantat hade — Abram zismu seb'ay ab ma'ekel amlekti ta'ot yinebir nebere.)

Scene 3 of 25

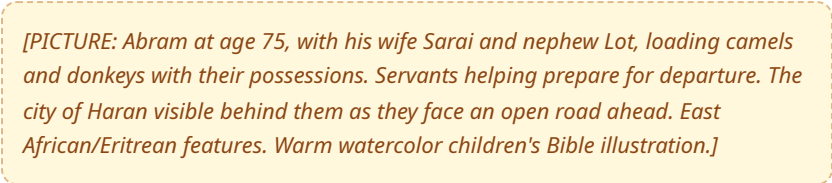
[PICTURE: God's promises visualized as golden light surrounding Abram - images of a great nation (many people), stars in the sky, and families of all nations being blessed radiating outward from Abram. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

With the command came extraordinary promises — promises so vast they seemed impossible for one elderly man to comprehend: "I will make you into a great nation. I will bless you and make your name great. You will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you and curse those who curse you. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." These were not modest promises. God was declaring that through this one act of obedience, through this single man's willingness to step into the unknown, every nation and every generation — including ours — would be forever changed. The weight of that covenant was staggering.

ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय ॥ — भगवत्पूजा के अनेक विधानों में से एक विधान है "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय"। भगवत्पूजा के अनेक विधानों में से एक विधान है "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय"। भगवत्पूजा के अनेक विधानों में से एक विधान है "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय"।

(Mis ti'izaz filuyat tesfatat metsa — nihade zi'arege seb kird'o zeyk'al zimesil sefih tesfatat.)

Scene 4 of 25



Abram was seventy-five years old when he departed from Haran — an age when most people seek comfort and stability, not radical upheaval. He took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, all their possessions, and the servants they had acquired. Consider what this meant: at an age when retirement beckons, Abram chose adventure. When certainty called, he chose mystery. When comfort whispered, he chose obedience. The text says simply, "So Abram went, as the Lord had told him." No recorded argument. No negotiation. No demand for more details. Just obedience. This is what mature faith looks like — not blind, but willing.

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(Abram kab Haran kiwets'e seb'a hamusht amettu nebere — bizuhat sebat mich'otin rig'atin zideliyullu edme.)

[PICTURE: Abram's caravan traveling through vast, empty desert landscape. A long line of camels, donkeys, and people stretching across golden sand dunes under a wide open sky. The journey feels both lonely and majestic. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The journey from Haran to Canaan was roughly four hundred miles — weeks of travel through unfamiliar terrain with no GPS, no established roads, and no guarantee of safety. Every step took Abram further from everything familiar and deeper into dependence on God alone. This is the nature of faith: it is not a single decision made once, but a daily choice to keep walking when the destination remains invisible. Each morning Abram woke up and chose to continue. Each night he slept under foreign stars and trusted that God's word was more reliable than his own understanding.

[illegible]

(Kab Haran nab Kene'an zikewn gu'zo astat arba'e mi'iti mayls nebere — semunt nay gu'zo bizyefeltte bota.)

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: Abram arriving in Canaan, standing on a hilltop overlooking a green and fertile land. He builds a stone altar under a great oak tree at Shechem, with his hands raised in worship. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Abram arrived in Canaan, God appeared to him at the great tree of Moreh at Shechem and said, "To your offspring I will give this land." There was one significant problem: Abram had no offspring. He was seventy-five, Sarai was sixty-five, and they were childless. Yet Abram built an altar there — an act of worship and a stake in the ground declaring he believed God's promise even when his circumstances contradicted it completely. Faith often requires us to worship before we see the fulfillment, to give thanks for what exists only as a promise.

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(Abram ab Kene'an mis bets'he, Amlakh ab abay om More ab Shekem tera'eyo "neza midri nizeri'ika kihba iye" belo.)

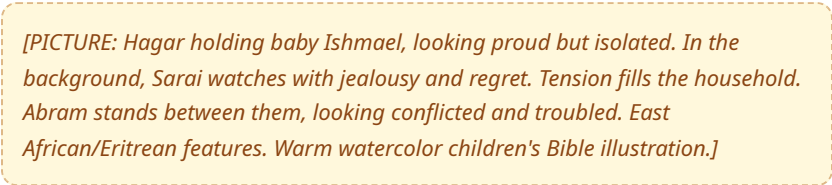
[PICTURE: Abram standing outside his tent at night, God's presence represented by warm light above him. Abram gazes at an impossibly vast night sky filled with countless brilliant stars. His expression shows both wonder and struggle. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Years passed — perhaps ten or more — and still no child. One night, God came to Abram in a vision: "Do not be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your very great reward." But Abram, for the first time, voiced his frustration honestly: "Sovereign Lord, what can you give me since I remain childless?" God did not rebuke this honesty. Instead, He took Abram outside and said, "Look up at the sky and count the stars — if indeed you can count them. So shall your offspring be." And Abram believed the Lord, and it was credited to him as righteousness. This is the pivotal moment — faith was not perfection but trust despite unanswered questions.

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(Ametat haleffe — minalbat aserte wey li'li'u — gena qol'a yelen. Hade leyti Amlakh nab Abram bira'iy metse.)

Scene 9 of 25



Hagar conceived and bore a son, Ishmael, when Abram was eighty-six years old. But instead of peace, the household erupted in conflict. Hagar despised Sarai; Sarai blamed Abram; bitterness poisoned every relationship. The "solution" had created problems far worse than the original waiting. This is always the consequence of running ahead of God — we create complications that ripple through generations. Ishmael was loved by God and blessed with his own destiny, but he was not the child of promise. Human shortcuts to divine plans always carry unintended consequences.

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(Hagar tenisa wedi weledet, Isma'el, Abram semaniya shidishte amettu kelo. Gin ab kindi selam geza bigrijit tefenjere.)

[PICTURE: A dramatic name-changing scene - the name "ABRAM" transforming into "ABRAHAM" in glowing letters above the kneeling figure, with divine breath (represented as golden wind) adding the letters. Stars and nations symbolized in the background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then God did something remarkable — He changed their names. Abram, meaning "exalted father," became Abraham, meaning "father of many nations." Sarai became Sarah, meaning "princess" — mother of nations and kings. These were not mere label changes; they were identity declarations. Every time someone called Abraham's name, they were prophesying his destiny. Every time Sarah heard her new name, she was reminded of God's promise. God renamed them according to what they would become, not what they currently were. He saw the end from the beginning and invited them to live into their future identity.

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(*Dihr'iu Amlakh zidenq neger gebere — simom qeyere. Abram tirgumu "li'lul abo" nab Abraham tirgumu "abo bizuhath hagerath" teqeyere.*)

Scene 12 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham fallen on his face but with a wide smile - laughing. A thought bubble shows a 100-year-old man holding a newborn baby, emphasizing the absurdity and wonder of the promise. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When God announced that Sarah herself would bear a son within a year, Abraham fell facedown — and laughed. "Will a son be born to a man a hundred years old? Will Sarah bear a child at the age of ninety?" This was not mocking laughter but the honest response of a man confronting the impossible. The beautiful truth is that God did not condemn Abraham's laughter. He even told Abraham to name the child "Isaac," which means "he laughs." God incorporated Abraham's honest doubt into the story of fulfillment. Faith does not require us to suppress our humanity — it invites us to bring our whole selves, laughter and confusion included, before God.

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(Amlakh Sara ba'la ab wishtti hade amet wedi kem tiwelid mis aweji, Abraham bigetsyu wediqu — sehaqi.)

Scene 13 of 25

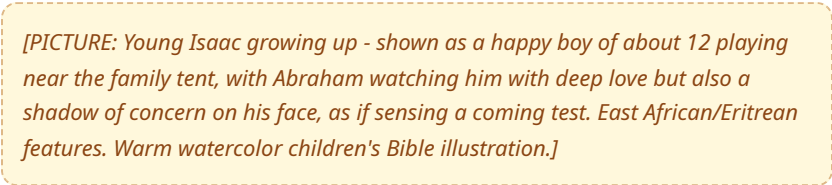
[PICTURE: Three mysterious visitors approaching Abraham's tent in the heat of the day. Abraham rushing to greet them with deep hospitality, bowing low. Sarah visible near the tent entrance preparing food. The visitors have a divine glow about them. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

One scorching afternoon, as Abraham sat at the entrance of his tent, three visitors appeared. Abraham, demonstrating extraordinary hospitality, rushed to meet them, bowed to the ground, and insisted on preparing a lavish meal. He brought water for their feet, had Sarah bake fresh bread, and selected a choice calf for the feast. Abraham did not yet fully realize who these visitors were — the Lord Himself and two angels. Sometimes God comes to us in ordinary moments, disguised in everyday encounters, testing whether we will respond with generosity before we know who is watching.

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(Hade wu'i dihri qetri Abraham ab af dege dinkwanu tegemitu kelo seleste betshti tera'eyu.)

Scene 17 of 25



Isaac grew, and Abraham's love for him was immeasurable. This was the child of promise — the miracle son, the embodiment of twenty-five years of faith and waiting. Abraham invested everything in Isaac: his hopes, his legacy, his understanding of God's covenant. Isaac was not merely Abraham's son; he was the living proof that God keeps His word. But God was about to ask something of Abraham that would test the very foundations of his faith — something so radical, so devastating, that it would either destroy Abraham's trust or reveal its ultimate depth.

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(Yishaq abeye, fiqri Abraham ni'u dima zeylika'e nebere. Izi nay tesfa qol'a nebere — nay te'amrat wedi.)

Scene 18 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham awake in the dark of night, sitting up in bed with a stricken expression. God's voice represented as light piercing the darkness. The weight of what has been asked is visible on Abraham's face - anguish mixed with resolve. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Abraham!" God called. "Here I am," he replied. Then came the words that must have shattered his heart: "Take your son, your only son Isaac, whom you love, and go to the region of Moriah. Sacrifice him there as a burnt offering on a mountain I will show you." Notice how God described Isaac — "your son, your only son, whom you love" — as if emphasizing the magnitude of what He was asking. God was not testing whether Abraham loved Him; He was testing whether Abraham trusted Him enough to surrender even the promise itself back into God's hands.

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(Abraham! Amlakh tsew'a. Abzi aleku, melese. Dihir'iu libu zisebir qalat metse.)

Scene 19 of 25

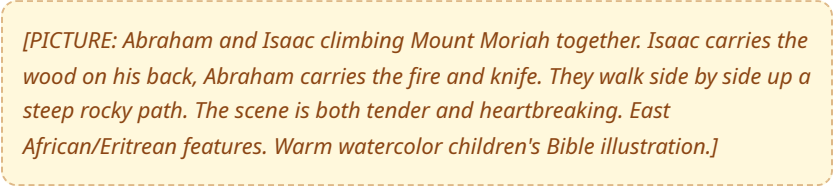
[PICTURE: Early morning - Abraham saddling his donkey in pre-dawn light, cutting wood for the offering. Young Isaac sleeping peacefully nearby, unaware. Two servants prepare for the journey. Abraham's face shows quiet determination through tears. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Early the next morning — not after days of deliberation, but immediately — Abraham rose, saddled his donkey, cut enough wood for the burnt offering, and set out with Isaac and two servants toward the place God had told him about. The text records no argument, no bargaining, no delay. Abraham had learned through decades of walking with God that obedience delayed is obedience denied. Whatever internal struggle he experienced — and it must have been agonizing — he chose to act on what he knew of God's character rather than what he could not understand about God's command.

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(Nitsbahitu angihu — dihri me'altitat mhsab zeykone gin qelttifu — Abraham tensiu adgu tse'inu ninay mihrar meswa'eti zi'akl enjeyti qoriitsu.)

Scene 20 of 25



On the third day, Abraham saw the place in the distance. He told his servants, "Stay here. The boy and I will go over there. We will worship and then we will come back to you." Notice: "We will come back." Abraham believed that even if he sacrificed Isaac, God would raise him from the dead — because God had promised that through Isaac his offspring would be reckoned. Abraham's faith had reached a level that defied logic: he trusted God's character so completely that he believed God could solve an impossible equation. Isaac, carrying the wood on his back, asked the question that pierces every parent's heart: "Father, where is the lamb for the burnt offering?"

Abraham said to his servants, "Stay here with the donkey. I and the boy will go over there and worship, and then we will come back to you." Abraham believed that even if he sacrificed Isaac, God would raise him from the dead — because God had promised that through Isaac his offspring would be reckoned. Abraham's faith had reached a level that defied logic: he trusted God's character so completely that he believed God could solve an impossible equation. Isaac, carrying the wood on his back, asked the question that pierces every parent's heart: "Father, where is the lamb for the burnt offering?"

(Ab salisay me'alti Abraham neti bota kab rihuq re'aye. Ni'agelgelto "abzi tsinhu. Anen qol'an nab'u kinkeyid ina. Kinemilkh ina dihri'u dima nabakhatkum kinmiles ina" below.)

Scene 21 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham with tears streaming down his face, answering Isaac's question. His hand rests on Isaac's shoulder. The words "God himself will provide the lamb" seem to glow between them like a prophecy. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abraham answered with words that were both an expression of faith and a prophecy that would echo through centuries: "God himself will provide the lamb for the burnt offering, my son." In that moment, Abraham spoke more truth than he could possibly know. He was prophesying about a distant mountain where God would indeed provide His own Lamb — His own Son — as a sacrifice for all humanity. Abraham's faith in that excruciating moment produced words that transcended his understanding. When we trust God in our darkest hours, He often speaks eternal truth through our trembling voices.

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(Abraham biqalat nay imnet geletsan ab zemanat zidwel tinbitin bizkone melese, "Amlakh ba'lu ninay mihrar meswa'eti genshel kidalu iyu wedey.")

Scene 22 of 25

[PICTURE: The altar built on Mount Moriah. Abraham with raised knife, Isaac bound on the wood. An angel of the Lord descending urgently from heaven with hand outstretched shouting "Stop!" Divine light breaking through storm clouds above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abraham built the altar, arranged the wood, bound Isaac, and laid him on it. Then he reached out his hand and took the knife to slay his son. At that very instant — not a moment sooner, not a moment later — the angel of the Lord called from heaven: "Abraham! Abraham! Do not lay a hand on the boy. Do not do anything to him. Now I know that you fear God, because you have not withheld from me your son, your only son." The test was complete. God had never intended for Isaac to die — He needed to know that Abraham's love for God surpassed even his love for the promise. Abraham had passed the ultimate test of faith: holding nothing back.

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(Abraham mesew'i serihu enjeyti seri'u ni'Yishaq asiru ab li'li'u aqemeto. Dihri'u idu zergihu niwidu kihrid kara haze.)

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham looking up with tears of relief to see a ram caught by its horns in a thicket nearby. Isaac unbound and embracing his father. The ram glows with divine provision. The altar and knife lie abandoned. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abraham looked up and there in a thicket he saw a ram caught by its horns. God had provided — exactly as Abraham had prophesied to Isaac. He sacrificed the ram instead of his son and named that place "The Lord Will Provide" — Jehovah Jireh. On the mountain of the Lord, it will be provided. This principle stands eternal: God never asks us to surrender something without providing something in return. He never empties our hands without filling them with something greater. The ram was God's answer to Abraham's faith — provision that appeared only after obedience was demonstrated.

Abraham niila'li temitu ab guttit biqernu zitetahze dib'ela re'aye. Amlakh adaliyu nebere — kem Abraham ni'Yishaq zinebyo bilk'e.)

(Abraham niila'li temitu ab guttit biqernu zitetahze dib'ela re'aye. Amlakh adaliyu nebere — kem Abraham ni'Yishaq zinebyo bilk'e.)

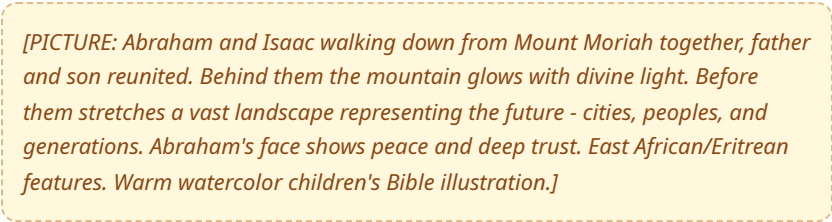
[PICTURE: God's covenant blessings flowing from Mount Moriah through time - showing generations branching out like a great tree, with Abraham at the root, leading through David's crown to a cross on a distant hill, representing Christ. Stars fill the sky above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God reaffirmed His covenant with an oath: "Because you have done this and have not withheld your son, your only son, I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore. Through your offspring all nations on earth will be blessed." This promise cascaded through generations — through Isaac, Jacob, the twelve tribes, King David, and ultimately to Jesus Christ, the true Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world. Abraham's single act of faith on Mount Moriah set in motion the redemption story for all humanity. One man's obedience can change the trajectory of history itself.

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(Amlakh qal kidanu bimehala aregagetse, "nezi sle zigeberka widka'wn beynu widka sle zeykelelka birigts kibarikeka zeri'ka'wn kem kewakhbiti semay kem hutsa gemagim bahri kibizihom iye.")

Scene 25 of 25



Abraham and Isaac walked down from that mountain together — father and son, their bond deeper than ever, forged in the fire of the ultimate test. Abraham had learned the final lesson of faith: that God can be trusted absolutely, even when His commands make no human sense. His journey from Ur to Moriah had taken decades and covered countless miles, but the real distance traveled was internal — from partial trust to complete surrender, from knowing about God to knowing God intimately. Abraham became the father of faith not because he never doubted, but because he obeyed despite his doubt. His legacy teaches us that faith is not a feeling — it is a decision to trust God's character when we cannot trace His hand.

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(Abrahamn Yishaqin kabti keren bihansi'e weredu — abon wedin miti'issarom kab kulu gize zi'amiqe bihawi nay meweda'eta fetena zitehantsii.)

[illegible]

Discussion Questions for Teens / 青少年的讨论问题

问题

1. **Has God ever asked you to leave something comfortable or familiar behind in order to grow?**
What did that feel like, and how did you respond? How might Abraham's example of immediate obedience challenge the way you handle God's direction in your life?
2. **Abraham waited twenty-five years for Isaac. What is the longest you have ever waited for something you believed God promised?** How do you maintain faith during extended seasons of waiting when nothing seems to be happening? What does Abraham's story teach about God's timing versus ours?
3. **When Sarai suggested using Hagar, Abraham agreed to a human shortcut.** Can you think of times when you've tried to "help God" by forcing outcomes rather than waiting for His timing? What were the consequences? How can we distinguish between wise action and impatient human engineering?
4. **Abraham laughed at God's promise, and God wasn't offended — He even named Isaac "laughter."** What does this tell us about how God handles our honest doubts? Is there a difference between honest questioning and rebellious unbelief? How can we bring our doubts to God without losing faith?
5. **The ultimate test required Abraham to surrender Isaac — the very thing God had promised.** What is the "Isaac" in your life — the thing you love so much it

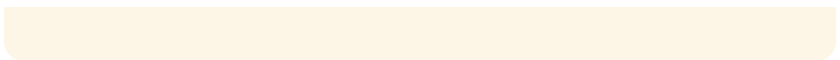
might rival your trust in God? Why do you think God sometimes asks us to hold our greatest blessings with open hands rather than clenched fists?

Prayer / 禱告

Dear Heavenly Father, thank You for the example of Abraham — a man who was not perfect but who chose to trust You again and again. Give us the courage to obey when You call us to leave our comfort zones, even when we cannot see where You are leading. Teach us patience in seasons of waiting, knowing that You are preparing both us and our future. Forgive us for the times we have tried to force Your promises through human effort instead of trusting Your perfect timing. Help us hold our blessings with open hands, knowing that You are more trustworthy than any gift You give. Strengthen our faith not to be the absence of doubt, but the presence of obedience. May we, like Abraham, be called faithful — not because we never questioned, but because we never stopped following. In Jesus' name, Amen.

天父上帝，謝謝你為亞伯拉罕——一個並不完美卻選擇一次又一次地信靠你的例子。賜給我們勇氣，當你呼召我們離開舒適圈，即使我們無法看見你帶領我們前往何方。教導我們在等候的季節裡有耐心，因為你知道你正在為我們和我們的未來預備。寬恕我們那些試圖透過人的努力，而不是信靠你完美的時機，去強迫你的應許。幫助我們敞開雙手，持守祝福，因為你比任何禮物都更值得信賴。堅固我們的信心，不是沒有懷疑，而是有順服。願我們像亞伯拉罕一樣，被稱為忠信——不是因為我們從不質疑，而是因為我們從不停止跟隨。在耶穌的名義下，阿門。

"By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going."
— Hebrews 11:8



Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 51 of 60

Abraham's faith journey teaches us that trusting God is not a one-time decision but a lifetime of daily choices. From leaving Ur to climbing Mount Moriah, every step required fresh surrender. His story reminds us that God's promises are worth waiting for, that doubt does not disqualify us, and that obedience — even when it costs everything — always leads to provision and blessing beyond what we could imagine.

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